

What is plagiarism?

Using the words or ideas of others in your work without proper acknowledgement, (referencing) is plagiarism. Therefore the ideas of others whether quoted directly or expressed in your own words must be correctly referenced if plagiarism is to be avoided.

Plagiarism may be deliberate or accidental, so it is vital that you understand what it is and how to avoid it. The seriousness with which St Michael's College regards plagiarism is indicated by the **St. Michael's plagiarism policy** which can be found in the front of the student diary.

Plagiarism may take the form of:

- **deliberate copying of another's work**,
(published or unpublished; this includes copying and pasting from electronic sources such as the Internet or CD-ROMs)
- **quoting another's words without acknowledgement**,
(this may be deliberate or accidental, and often occurs as a result of careless note taking, or copying and pasting)
- **expressing another's ideas in your own words without acknowledgement**,
(this may be deliberate or accidental, and it doesn't matter if you've changed the original wording, acknowledgement is still required.)
- **submitting someone else's work as if it is your own**

The Internet deserves special mention because it is the source of much of today's plagiarism. The above definitions of plagiarism apply equally to the Internet, and in fact because of the relative ease of publishing on the Internet, (including in some cases plagiarised, misleading and deliberately deceptive material), it is essential that you assess sites for accuracy and reliability. (Check the St. Michael's guide to assessing web sites.)

Avoiding plagiarism

- Use the Information Process to guide your research to ensure you find a variety of useful sources of information.
- Make sure you understand what plagiarism is, (see What is plagiarism? above).
- Make sure you understand how to reference, and check with your teacher what level of referencing is expected for particular assignments.
- Make sure you record details about all your sources of information. (The Reference and note taking sheet can be useful for this task.)
- Note take from sources. Make sure you clearly identify where you have copied quotations and where you have used your own words.
- Make sure when you use your own words to express another's ideas that you have not simply altered a few words in the original text.

More information

To learn more about plagiarism and how it can be avoided visit the excellent [HSC: all my own work](#) and the [Avoiding plagiarism](#) pages on the University of South Australia site.

[All my own work - Plagiarism quiz \[All my own work - lesson 2\]](#)

AVOIDING PLAGIARISM

All my own work - Acknowledging sources quiz [All my own work - lesson 3]